REWARD FUND IS GROWING

Citizens of Villisca Subscribe Over $1,000 and Subscription is Being Taken at Clarinda—No Trouble to Get Signers to Papers

The reward fund continues to grow and to date exceeds $1,000. Voluntary subscriptions have been received at the Villisca National bank and by other citizens to date as follows:

We the undersigned agree to pay the amount set opposite our names for the purpose of a reward for the arrest and conviction of the murderer or murderers of J. B. Moore and family and the two children of Jos. T. Stillinger. In case the murderer or murderers are brought in dead a reward of One Hundred Dollars will be paid to be apportioned among the signers of this paper. This reward is to hold good only if capture is made within six months from date, June 11th, 1912.

F M Dirrim	$10 00
Hal Hausen	10
W H Weber	10
J McIntosh	10
John Reeves	10
W G Davie	10
F F Jones	10
Curtis & Scott	10
Omer Day	10
R S Poston	1
G M Roth	1
Whitney & Taylor	5
Green Bay Lbr. Co	5
C M Orr	5
Means & Burnham	5
D E Lomas	10
Thos. Cooney	2
Wm Giese	5
Farquhar & Rice	10
H H Heinsfurter	5
Smith & Wallace	5
F S Williams	5
E Northup	1
E C Gibbs	5
E C Hough	5
W A Stillians	5
Arbuckle Bros	5
J L Himiller	5
J A Copeland	5
T S Wright	5
Geo W Horton	5
J W Newell	5
W A Lomas	5
Taylor King	2
J S Honeyman	5
Albert F Davie	5
M Cowgill	5
N B Wilson	5
A D Wycoff	5
J M Tinsley	5
C A Stickler	2
Bowers & Gile	2
W B Woodward	5
Edwards Bros	5
W H Willett	5
M P Bible	1
J W Mitchell	5
E A Patterson	1
Lewis Bros	1
I M Wickersham	1
W E Sandell	1
A F Henderson	1
A Poston	1
R R Harris	2
W A Simons	1
W E Brodrick	1
C Nyhus	1
W O Zaelke	1
W R Finlayson	5
C F Larson	5
C E Anderson	1
H Holland	5
Fred B Jump	5
H C Weber	3
Thos G Brenton	2 50
W J Oviatt	1
W H Barr	5
C Sadler	1
A J Wertman	5
W D Reynolds	5
G H Robinson	5
W H Reynolds	5
Wash Marsh	1
B H Egleston	2 50
F B Taylor	5
Bert Berg	5
F M Childs	5
Wm Zuberi	1
A W Overman	1
Julius Fengel	1
W H Wilson	1
J T Poston	1
J L Palmquist	1
Albert Jones	5
W J Egleston	5
Oto Peterson	1
John Holdren	1
F P Tyler	3
Stoddard Lbr Co	3
Elias Smith	1
Saml Beveridge	1
Edward Day	5
P D Minick	5
Eugene Stoddard	5
T N Watts	1
M V Western	2
W W Arnold	1
B F Fast	10
A T Curtis	1
L Jack & Son	1
B F Clayton	5
J S Lewis	1
Ed Selley	5
J B Moore Imp Co	25
Ed H Landers	1 50
W A Atwood	2
D W Wedlin	1
N R Fuller	2
H D Peckham	2
H C Foster	1
C N Fessler	2

(Continued on Page 7)



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Sandy soils give quick results in plant growth, while the richer and heavier soils give size and yield.

In everyday life, as in politics, a fellow is quite often as accurately judged by the enemies as by the friends he makes.

The incubator and brooder have this advantage over old Biddy—namely, that chicks handled in the artificial way are not so likely to be infested with lice.

Being long without water is said by an experienced horseman to be the cause of most cases of colic in horses. The remedy for the trouble, if this diagnosis is correct, would seem to be cheap enough to suit the most economical.

Sunshine is one of the cheapest and best disinfectants known. Not only should lots of it be admitted into the dairy barn and poultry house, but the rugs, bedding and clothing that are stored in the closets should be exposed to it now and then.

Poultry manure is one of the richest of natural manures and should be applied sparingly, it being best mixed with barnyard manure before being put on the land. If one wants to store hen manure for some time it should be kept as dry as possible.

The urging of a better type of agriculture is not a whim, but a virtual necessity, for land values have reached such a level that better methods must be adopted to give returns that will meet both interest and taxes and leave a margin for profit. When land will not do this the danger line is already crossed.

Germany, one-fifteenth as large as the United States, produces nearly five times as many potatoes as we do. Her acreage in potatoes is twice and a half what it is in this country and the yield per acre about twice as large. Roughly, one half the crop is consumed and the other half used in the manufacture of starch and denatured alcohol.

After a good deal of fireworks of one kind and another fired off before the agricultural committee of the lower house it has been decided to postpone further action on the oleomargarine measure until Dec. 4 It is apparent from this that the politicians didn't dare support the bill for fear of offending the dairy interests nor oppose it because of the wrath of the consumer who wants a cheap substitute for butter.

The most difficult as well as the most dangerous piece of engineering work thus far undertaken by the reclamation service is the building of a 1,000 cubic foot siphon tunnel 100 feet beneath the Colorado river and extending from California to Yuma, Ariz. This work has lately been completed, and the water will be turned into the canal within a short time. The project will furnish water for 100,000 acres of the most fertile land in the southwest.

Just because potatoes were outrageously high this spring is no good reason why everybody should begin raising them. Neither should it serve as an argument why the usual number of folks should not do so. Potatoes may be a bumper crop next fall while, on the other hand, they may be very scarce. Nobody has any insight as to what weather conditions are going to be, so the prospects for a good return from potatoes planted are just as good as usual.

The Oregon Agricultural college has given a new turn to the "special car" method of popular agricultural education by equipping and sending out a poultry special. On April 27 the car had visited twenty-six towns and cities and demonstrations and lectures had been given before 11,000 people. An interesting feature of the equipment was two hens—a Plymouth Rock and White Leghorn—which were laying each an egg a day while the train was en route, while other hens of the same breeds were eating the same rations, but doing nothing.

In the same stable, with Banostine Belle De Kol, the new queen of the dairy world, whose record was given in a recent issue of these notes, is Daisy Grace De Kol, also a Holstein, that holds the world's junior four-year-old milk and butter record, her production of milk for the period being 24,718 pounds (nearly eleven tons), while her production of butter fat from this milk was 992 pounds, equivalent to 1,200 pounds of butter. Unless some misfortune befalls this cow it is more than likely she will be the holder of the world's record for all ages before she is three years older.

The pigs are surely in "clover" when they have the run of an alfalfa pasture. Not only do they relish the green food, but it does them good and puts flesh on their ribs.

Asparagus rust, a fungous disease that was introduced into this country from Europe twenty years ago and which for a long time was given little heed, is today the most troublesome pest that truck gardeners have to contend with.

A good many reform movements are run on a good deal the same line as cutting dandelions out by hand when adjoining lots are allowed to mature fluffy heads by the hundred for the wind to scatter hither and yon. It is a pitifully inadequate adaptation of means to ends.

Before transplanting the tomato, egg pepper and other plants from the hotbed, they should be hardened by reducing the amount of water used in sprinkling them and by keeping the sash off. When they have had time to get used to the outdoor conditions they may be taken up.

What is said to be the largest milk yield and butter fat record ever made by a grade dairy cow is held by Beauty, a grade Guernsey cow belonging to a Wisconsin breeder. She produced in one year 12,194 pounds of milk, which contained 777.9 pounds of butter fat. Surely this is no scrub performance.

For some years past the state of Illinois has employed convict labor in crushing limestone, to be sold at cost to the farmers of the state. Virginia plans to do the same thing, and other states will likely follow suit If convicts can just be instrumental in "sweetening the sour old world" up a bit they will have performed a useful mission

A reader of this department asks whether it will damage blue grass to apply air slaked lime on it. If scattered thinly it would do no particular harm Neither would any benefit result unless the soil were inclined to be wet and sour, in which case the lime would serve to sweeten it and correct an acid condition. Usually where this is the case the grass is thin or does not grow at all, while sorrel is likely to come up in its place.

It is pretty hard to improve on earthworms as a bait for suckers and redhorse. The writer remembers well when a lad that the small boys of the neighborhood got it into their heads that putting a couple of drops of anise oil on the baited hook would draw the fish. He tried this, but without result, and after he quit using the dope the fish began to bite. In the meantime the bottle of oil had got uncorked in his breastcoat pocket, and he dreamed about anise oil by night and smelled it by day time for weeks afterward. Just plain "gums" are good enough.

If your lawn is infested with dandelions and you are weary of getting down on your prayer bones to dig them out try a spray of iron sulphate, which has been thoroughly tested and found very effective. Dissolve one and one fourth pounds of the chemical (also called copperas or green vitriol) to each gallon of water and apply to the lawn with a small spray pump, covering thoroughly. Give a second spraying in about two weeks after the first, and a third about a fortnight later. The grass will look sick along with the dandelions, but will recover and be the fresher for the treatment.

The agricultural commissioners of Ontario have lately installed a system of market reporting that has much to commend it. Briefly the system is operated by means of bulletin boards placed at all stations where produce is received for shipment. On these are given not only the day's prices for a given list of commodities, but also a list of firms with addresses in different parts of the province who want such and such quantities of this and that commodity. These market bulletins are corrected daily from reports received from reliable sources and prove of great service to the provincial farmer and gardener.

With commercial fertilizers coming more and more into use there is need for the exercise of caution on the part of those buying them for the first time along the line of buying those that are guaranteed to contain the largest possible per cent of the fertilizing elements they are supposed to contain One fertilizer may look just like another and be represented as being just as good as that sold under some other brand, yet not be worth more than a half or two-thirds as much The proposition is a good deal the same as that of buying a dairy cow One may give milk testing barely 3 per cent and another milk testing 5 or 6 per cent of butter fat.

Now and then some of our readers have seen references in horticultural journals to plugging up the holes in hollow fruit trees with cement to prevent decay. One who examined several trees which had been treated in this fashion found that this mode of treatment instead of preventing decay of the heartwood of the trees had actually hastened it. This seems to have been due to the same cause—lack of air—which causes the under timbers of a house to rot out much more quickly if there are no openings left in the foundation through which the air can circulate. Fresh air is a check to fungous growth, and for this reason the holes in the apple tree trunks should be left open.

RELIEF IN SIGHT.

The great need for a federal plant quarantine and inspection law which will prevent the importation of disease and pest infested nursery stock into the United States from foreign countries, as well as the shipment of it from one state into another, bids fair to be met if bills which have been introduced in both houses of congress are enacted into law. The bill as originally drafted is H R. 21,291, but following its reference to the house committee some changes have been suggested, and these have been embodied in H. R. 22,728, which, it is proposed, shall be substituted for the original bill when the latter is brought up for consideration. The bill as drawn provides that it shall be unlawful for any person to import or offer for entry into the United States any nursery stock unless a permit shall have been issued therefor by the secretary of agriculture and the latter shall be the judge of several conditions under which such permits shall be granted. The bill also prohibits the shipment from one state to another of nursery stock that has been imported unless the secretary of agriculture has been notified of the history of the shipment and the same has been properly inspected and labeled. The bill further empowers the secretary to restrict the importation of any plants, fruits, vegetables, roots, bulbs, seeds or other plant products not included under the term "nursery stock" whenever he believes their admission might result in the introduction of injurious plant or insect pests. He may also quarantine any state or district of the United States in which plant or insect pests gained a foothold Full authority is given the secretary to make the regulations necessary to carry the provisions of the measure into effect. For the proper enforcement of the bill it provides for the creation of a federal board of horticulture, which shall consist of five members, including representatives from the bureau of entomology, the bureau of plant industry and the forest service. Twenty-five thousand dollars is appropriated by the bill to carry its provisions into effect, and it becomes operative on July 1, 1912, if passed In a personal letter to the writer from Secretary Wilson in response to an inquiry about the matter he writes "I hope you will commend this bill to the attention of your senators, and I appreciate your interest in this legislation. No more needed or useful legislation can be enacted by this congress than this plant quarantine and inspection bill." The writer would pass this injunction along and urge the readers of this department to write their representatives and senators urging support of the measure. Its passage is of the utmost importance to both horticultural and agricultural interests, and on these much of our prosperity depends. Our country is the only one of the leading countries that does not now have adequate inspection laws. It is high time we joined the procession.

SAVE YOUR HAY.

With best grades of tame hay selling at from $20 to $30 per ton on eastern markets and with many meadows knocked out by last summer's drought or the past winter's severe cold, the prospects would seem to be good that hay prices will hold to an unusually high level during the entire present year. This means that the forehanded farmer will not only handle his hay crop in the best manner possible, but will increase his supply of substitutes for hay to the maximum. These will include not only fresh cut corn to tide over the period of short pasture, but silage secured next September. If one has not yet installed a silo the general conditions were never better for doing so as a means of helping out the hay shortage

SPARROWS ON TOAST.

Biologist Dearborn of the department of agriculture suggests, as a further incentive for the extermination of the English sparrow, the use of the bird for eating purposes, his contention being that "when they are boned, broiled, buttered and served on toast they are as fine as quail" In preparing the little fellows for cooking the bulletin gives the following directions: "Cut off the legs, the wings at the outer joints and the neck close to the body, strip off the skin beginning at the neck, make a cut through the body wall bone until the ribs are severed; then around between the legs to the tail and remove the viscera." There is no question that "sparrow on toast" would be lickin good if one could only get enough of 'em.

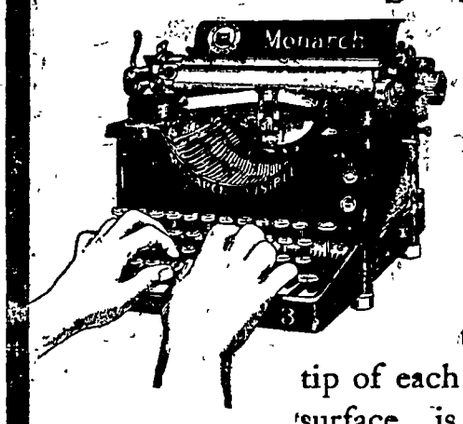
STORAGE OF EGGS.

Reports of larger market centers seem to show that the egg storage chaps are buying up huge quantities of fresh eggs to keep in storage until next fall and winter. It is this fact that is keeping eggs up close to the twenty cent mark when, under the conditions of present supply and demand based on actual needs, they would probably be down to a shilling a dozen For the consumer this means a somewhat higher price now, but the large quantities being put in storage will tend to serve as a price leveler next winter. The egg men remember the fifty cent eggs of last winter, but evidently have forgotten their egg storage grief of a few months before.

F. E. Trigg

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